

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD  
LAHONTAN REGION

**BOARD ORDER NO. 6-96-161**  
**WDID NO. 6B140704001**

REVISED WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS

FOR

**STOVEPIPE WELLS VILLAGE**  
**DEATH VALLEY NATIONAL PARK**  
**WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY**

\_\_\_\_\_  
Inyo County \_\_\_\_\_

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region (Regional Board) finds:

1. Discharger

Charles Thomas submitted a complete Revised Report of Waste Discharge for the United States Department of the Interior (USDI), National Park Service (NPS)- Death Valley National Park - Stovepipe Wells Village Wastewater Treatment Facility on October 2, 1996. For the purposes of this Regional Board Order (Order), the USDI - NPS Death Valley National Park, Stovepipe Wells Village is referred to as the "Discharger."

2. Facility

For the purposes of this Order, the Stovepipe Wells Village Wastewater Treatment Facility is referred to as the "Facility." The Facility discharges domestic wastewater.

3. Order History

The Regional Board previously established Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) for the Facility under Board Order No. 6-82-48, which was adopted on April 8, 1982.

4. Reason for Action

The Regional Board is revising the WDRs as part of a statewide program to periodically review and revise all outdated requirements. The former Death Valley National Monument has been reorganized as Death Valley National Park. These revised WDRs also update the requirements to comply with current Regional Board policies.

5. Facility Location

The Facility is located in Stovepipe Wells Village, Death Valley National Park, adjacent to Highway 190, seven miles west of the junction of California State Highway 190 and Nevada State Highway 374, in Inyo County, within the SE/4, SW/4, NE/4, Section 36, T15N, R44E, MDB&M, as shown on Attachment "A," which is made part of this Order.

6. Description of Facility and Discharge

The Facility collects, treats, and disposes of approximately 0.025 mgd of domestic wastewater from a resort motel and support facilities, including an 85-unit motel, 34-person dormitory, 26 recreational vehicle spaces, one residence, one restaurant/bar, one general store, one campground restroom, and showers associated with a swimming pool. The Facility is designed for a maximum of 0.030 mgd. The Facility consists of two evaporation/percolation disposal ponds which cover approximately one acre. To better accommodate increased flows, the Discharger plans to convert the two-pond disposal site into a one-pond system by elimination of the dividing dike.

7. Authorized Disposal Sites

The two evaporation/percolation disposal ponds are the only authorized disposal sites for wastewater. The authorized disposal site is located on land owned by the Discharger.

8. Site Geology

Soil at the Facility has been classified as recent and older alluvium.

9. Site Hydrogeology

Ground water is found at a depth of approximately 100 feet. Ground water contains elevated concentrations of sodium, fluoride, boron, and total dissolved solids.

10. Receiving Waters

The receiving waters are the ground waters of Death Valley (Department of Water Resources Basin No. 6-18).

11. Lahontan Basin Plan

The Regional Board adopted a Water Quality Control Plan for the Lahontan Basin (Basin Plan) which became effective on March 31, 1995, and this Order implements the Basin Plan.

12. Beneficial Uses

The beneficial uses of the ground waters of Death Valley as set forth and defined in the Basin Plan are:

- a. municipal and domestic supply
- b. agricultural supply
- c. freshwater replenishment
- d. wildlife habitat

13. California Environmental Quality Act Compliance

These WDRs govern an existing facility which the Discharger is currently operating. The project consists only of the continued operation of the existing facility governed by these WDRs and is therefore exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (Public Resources Code, Section 21000, et seq.) in accordance with Section 15301, Chapter 3, Title 14, California Code of Regulations.

14. Notification of Interested Parties

The Regional Board has notified the Discharger and interested parties of its intent to revise WDRs for the discharge.

15. Consideration of Public Comments

The Regional Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

**IT IS HEREBY ORDERED** that the Discharger shall comply with the following:

I. DISCHARGE SPECIFICATIONS

A. Discharge Limitations

1. The total flow of wastewater to the treatment and disposal facilities during a 24-hour period shall not exceed 0.030 million gallons.
2. All wastewater made available for percolation at the authorized disposal site shall have a pH of not less than 6.0 pH units nor more than 9.0 pH units.
3. All wastewater made available for percolation at the authorized disposal site shall have a dissolved oxygen concentration not less than 1.0 mg/l.

B. Receiving Water Limitations

The discharge of waste shall not cause the presence of the following substances or conditions in ground waters of the Amargosa Hydrologic Unit:

1. any perceptible color, odor, taste or foaming;
2. coliform organisms attributable to human wastes;
3. toxic substances in concentrations that individually, collectively, or cumulatively cause detrimental physiological responses in human, plants, animals, or aquatic life;

4. identifiable chlorinated hydrocarbons, organophosphates, carbamates, and other pesticide and herbicide groups, in summations, in excess of the lowest detectable levels; and
5. concentrations of chemical constituents in excess of the maximum contaminant levels or secondary maximum contaminant levels based upon drinking water standards specified by the more restrictive of the California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 4, Chapter 15, or 40 CFR, Part 141.

C. General Requirements and Prohibitions

1. There shall be no discharge, bypass, or diversion of raw or partially treated sewage, sewage sludge, grease, or oils from the collection, transport, treatment, or disposal facilities to adjacent land areas or surface waters.
2. Surface flow or visible discharge of sewage or sewage effluent from the authorized disposal site to adjacent land areas or surface waters is prohibited.
3. The vertical distance between the liquid surface elevation and the lowest point of a pond dike or the invert of an overflow structure shall not be less than two feet.
4. The discharge shall not cause a pollution as defined in Section 13050 of the California Water Code, or a threatened pollution.
5. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a nuisance as defined in Section 13050 of the California Water Code.
6. The discharge of wastewater except to the authorized disposal site is prohibited.
7. The Discharger shall comply with all existing Federal and State laws and regulations that apply to sewage sludge use and disposal practices.

II. PROVISIONS

A. Rescission of WDRs

Board Order No. 6-82-48 is hereby rescinded.

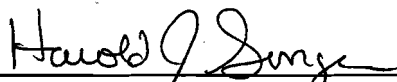
B. Standard Provisions

The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions for Waste Discharge Requirements," dated September 1, 1994, in Attachment "B", which is made part of this Order.

C. Monitoring and Reporting

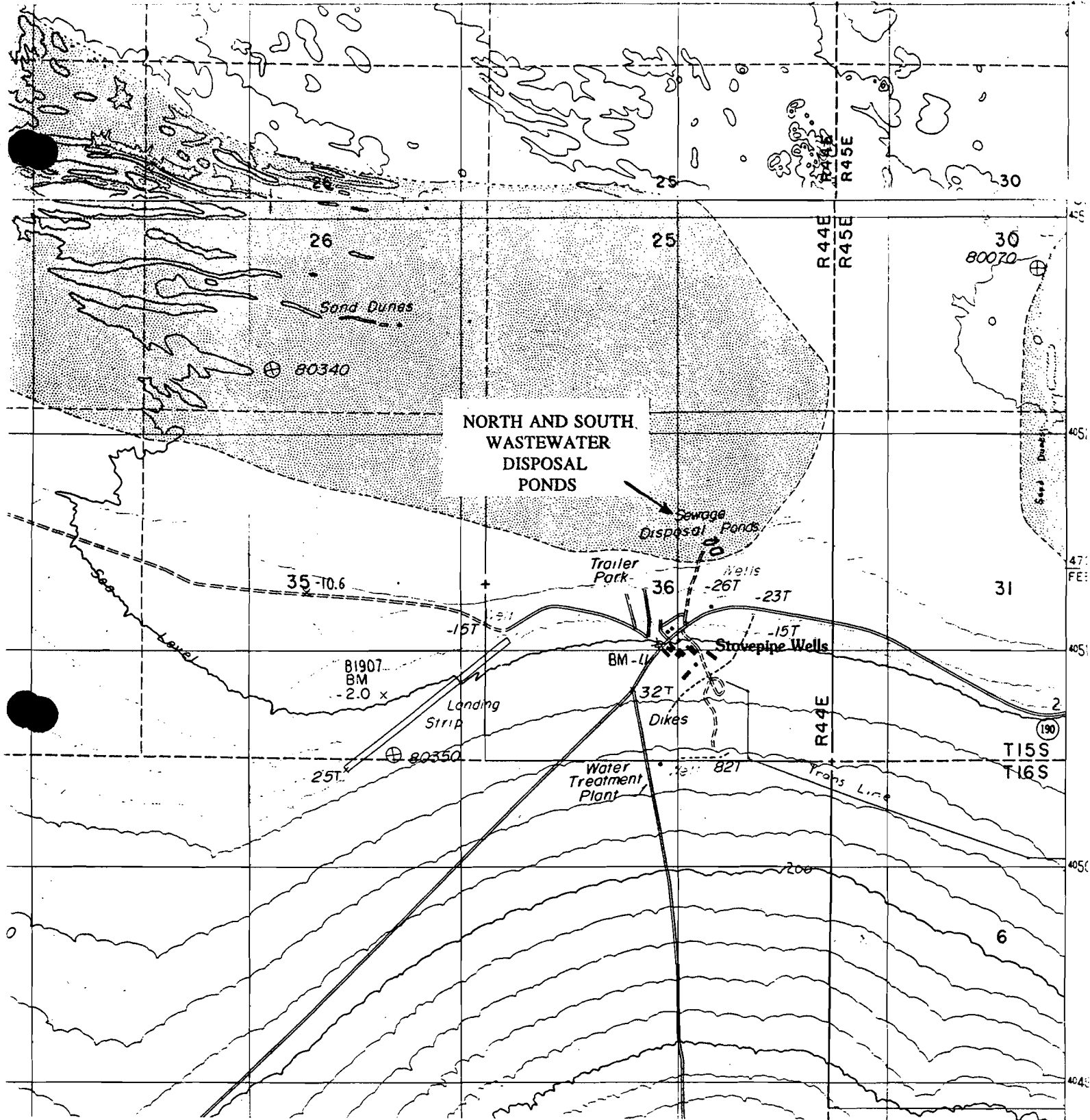
1. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13267(b), the Discharger shall comply with Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 96-161 as specified by the Executive Officer.
2. The Discharger shall comply with the "General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting," dated September 1, 1994, which is attached to and made part of the Monitoring and Reporting Program.

I, Harold J. Singer, Executive Officer, do hereby certify that the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region, on November 8, 1996.



HAROLD J. SINGER  
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Attachments: A. Location Map  
B. Standard Provisions for Waste Discharge Requirement



# ATTACHMENT "A"

STOVEPIPE WELLS VILLAGE

Inyo County, California

SE/4, SW/4, NE/4, Section 36, T15S, R44E, MDB&M

USGS Stovepipe Wells and Mesquite Flat 7.5 Minute Series Quadrangles  
(1988 Provisional Edition)

# CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD

## **STANDARD PROVISIONS** **FOR WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS**

### **1. Inspection and Entry**

The Discharger shall permit Regional Board staff:

- a. to enter upon premises in which an effluent source is located or in which any required records are kept;
- b. to copy any records relating to the discharge or relating to compliance with the Waste Discharge Requirements;
- c. to inspect monitoring equipment or records; and
- d. to sample any discharge.

### **2. Reporting Requirements**

- a. Pursuant to California Water Code 13267(b), the Discharger shall immediately notify the Regional Board by telephone whenever an adverse condition occurred as a result of this discharge; written confirmation shall follow within two weeks. An adverse condition includes, but is not limited to, spills of petroleum products or toxic chemicals, or damage to control facilities that could affect compliance.
- b. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13260(c), any proposed material change in the character of the waste, manner or method of treatment or disposal, increase of discharge, or location of discharge, shall be reported to the Regional Board at least 120 days in advance of implementation of any such proposal. This shall include, but not limited to, all significant soil disturbances.
- c. The Owners/Discharger of property subject to Waste Discharge Requirements shall be considered to have a continuing responsibility for ensuring compliance with applicable Waste Discharge Requirements in the operations or use of the owned property. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13260(c), any change in the ownership and/or operation of property subject to the Waste Discharge Requirements shall be reported to the Regional Board. Notification of applicable Waste Discharge Requirements shall be furnished in writing to the new owners and/or operators and a copy of such notification shall be sent to the Regional Board.
- d. If a Discharger becomes aware that any information submitted to the Regional Board is incorrect, the Discharger shall immediately notify the Regional Board, in writing and correct that information.
- e. Reports required by the Waste Discharge Requirements, and other information requested by the Regional Board, must be signed by a duly authorized representative of the Discharger. Under Section 13268 of the California Water Code, any person failing or refusing to furnish technical or monitoring reports, or falsifying any information provided therein, is guilty of a misdemeanor and may be liable civilly in an amount of up to one thousand dollars (\$1,000) for each day of violation.

10. Availability

A copy of the Waste Discharge Requirements shall kept and maintained by the Discharger and be available at all times to operating personnel.

11. Severability

Provisions of the Waste Discharge Requirements are severable. If any provision of the requirements is found invalid, the remainder of the requirements shall not be affected.

12. Public Access

General public access shall be effectively excluded from disposal/treatment facilities.

13. Transfers

Providing there is no material change in the operation of the facility, this Order may be transferred to a new owner or operator. The owner/operator must request the transfer in writing and receive written approval from the Regional Board's Executive Officer.

14. Definitions

- a. "Surface waters" as used in this Order, include, but are not limited to, live streams, either perennial or ephemeral, which flow in natural or artificial water courses and natural lakes and artificial impoundments of waters. "Surface waters" does not include artificial water courses or impoundments used exclusively for wastewater disposal.
- b. "Ground waters" as used in this Order, include, but are not limited to, all subsurface waters being above atmospheric pressure and the capillary fringe of these waters.

15. Storm Protection

- a. All facilities used for collection, transport, treatment, storage, or disposal of waste shall be adequately protected against overflow, washout, inundation, structural damage or a significant reduction in efficiency resulting from a storm or flood having a recurrence interval of once in 100 years.



CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD  
LAHONTAN REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 96-161  
WDID NO. 6B140704001

FOR

STOVEPIPE WELLS VILLAGE  
DEATH VALLEY NATIONAL PARK  
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY

Inyo County

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I. MONITORING

A. Flow Monitoring

The Discharger shall monitor the following:

1. The estimated total volume, in million gallons, of wastewater flow to the Facility for each month.
2. The freeboard (distance from the top of the lowest part of the dike to the wastewater surface in the pond) measured each month in each of the two disposal ponds. If a pond is not in use, indicate it is empty.
3. The total number and all types of sewer connections (i.e. hotel, residential, restaurant) discharging to the Facility for each annual monitoring period.
4. The total number of permanent employees and/or residents.

B. Sludge Monitoring

1. The Discharger shall submit a Sludge Management Plan (Plan) 90 days prior to any planned pond cleaning operation. The Plan shall outline actions necessary for the Discharger to be in compliance with all local, State and Federal laws and regulations. Copies of reports submitted to other agencies regarding sludge disposal operations shall be included in the Plan.

II. REPORTING

A General Provisions

The Discharger shall comply with the "General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting," dated September 1, 1994, which is attached to and made part of this Monitoring and Reporting Program.

STOVEPIPE WELLS VILLAGE  
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY  
Inyo County

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MONITORING AND REPORTING  
PROGRAM NO. 96-161  
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C. Submittal Periods

Beginning on **January 15, 1997**, an annual monitoring report including the preceding information shall be submitted to the Regional Board. Subsequent monitoring reports shall be submitted to the Regional Board by the 15th day of January each year.

Ordered by: Harold J. Singer Dated: November 8, 1996  
HAROLD J. SINGER  
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Attachment: General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD  
LAHONTAN REGION

GENERAL PROVISIONS  
FOR MONITORING AND REPORTING

I. SAMPLING AND ANALYSIS

- a. All analyses shall be performed in accordance with the current edition(s) of the following documents:
  - i. Standard Methods for the Examination of Water and Wastewater
  - ii. Methods for Chemical Analysis of Water and Wastes, EPA
- b. All analyses shall be performed in a laboratory certified to perform such analyses by the California State Department of Health Services or a laboratory approved by the Regional Board. Specific methods of analysis must be identified on each laboratory report.
- c. Any modifications to the above methods to eliminate known interferences shall be reported with the sample results. The method used shall also be reported. If methods other than USEPA approved methods or Standard Methods are used, the exact methodology must be submitted for review and must be approved by the Regional Board prior to use.
- d. The Discharger shall establish chain-of-custody procedures to ensure that specific individuals are responsible for sample integrity from commencement of sample collection through delivery to an approved laboratory. Sample collection, storage and analysis shall be conducted in accordance with an approved Sampling and Analysis Plan (SAP). The most recent version of the approved SAP shall be kept at the facility.
- e. The Discharger shall calibrate and perform maintenance procedures on all monitoring instruments and equipment to ensure accuracy of measurements, or shall ensure that both activities will be conducted. The calibration of any wastewater flow measuring device shall be recorded and maintained in the permanent log book described in 2.b, below.
- f. A grab sample is defined as an individual sample collected in fewer than 15 minutes.
- g. A composite sample is defined as a combination of no fewer than eight individual samples obtained over the specified sampling period at equal intervals. The volume of each individual sample shall be proportional to the discharge flow rate at the time of sampling. The sampling period shall equal the discharge period, or 24 hours, whichever period is shorter.

- iii. In the case of a sole proprietorship, by the proprietor;
  - iv. In the case of a municipal, state or other public facility, by either a principal executive officer, ranking elected official, or other duly authorized employee.
- e. Monitoring reports are to include the following:
- i. Name and telephone number of individual who can answer questions about the report.
  - ii. The Monitoring and Reporting Program Number.
  - iii. WDID Number.
- f. Modifications

This Monitoring and Reporting Program may be modified at the discretion of the Regional Board Executive Officer.

#### 4. NONCOMPLIANCE

Under Section 13268 of the Water Code, any person failing or refusing to furnish technical or monitoring reports or falsifying any information provided therein, is guilty of a misdemeanor and may be liable civilly in an amount of up to one thousand dollars (\$1,000) for each day of violation under Section 13268 of the Water Code.